



Delaware County Council Meeting April 26th 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9YbRsEuebPw
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Delaware County Council Regular Meeting Report

Meeting Date: April 26, 2022

Location: Delaware County Commissioner's Courtroom

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at [00:00:16](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Mr. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, and Council President Mr. Alexander.
 - **Members Absent:** (None noted as absent during roll calls).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ryan Ballard [00:00:25](#).
- **Approval of Agenda:** Approved via roll call vote following a motion by Mr. Piper and a second [00:02:03](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** March meeting minutes were approved via roll call vote following a motion by Mr. Piper and a second by Mr. Ballard [00:03:00](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:03:35](#) **Delaware County Circuit Court Magistrate Letter of Support**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Judge Linda Rae Louise Wolff (Delaware Circuit Court 3) and Ben (Council Attorney).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Judge Wolff presented a draft letter of support asking the Indiana General Assembly to establish a magistrate position for Delaware County Circuit Courts, which would replace the master commissioner currently in the budget. Council members discussed minor wording clarifications regarding pronouns in the draft.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously via roll call vote (Motion: Mr. Piper, Second: Mr. Ballard) [00:06:26](#).
- [00:07:22](#) **Financial Transfers & Addendums**
 - **Assessors ([00:07:36](#)):** Line-item transfers for employee replacement totaling zero net change. Approved via roll call vote (Motion: Mr. Piper, Second: Mr. Ballard).
 - **Circuit Court / Probation ([00:08:59](#)):** Chief Probation Officer Jeff Hansard requested special permission to fill a retiring veteran probation officer's vacancy effective May 2nd (ahead of the June 3rd benefit payout completion date) to allow for training. Discussed compliance with Hiring and Vacancy Ordinance 2017-05 (Council Attorney Ben confirmed the budget line item retains a positive balance due to a \$30,000 pay differential between a retiring 25+ year officer and a zero-year replacement). Approved via roll call vote (Motion: Mr. Piper, Second: Mr. Quakenbush) [00:19:43](#).
 - **Communication Center ([00:16:16](#) & [00:35:46](#)):** Transfers for communication technicians, staffing replacements, and a major stop-gap transfer of \$105,000/overtime-related line items presented by 9-1-1 Director Fred Cummings. Approved via roll call votes.
 - **EMS ([00:21:24](#) & [01:00:27](#)):** Line-item adjustments including a title-to-salary correction for an advanced EMT graduating to paramedic school, and capital improvements for replacement transmitters (Transmitter 443). Approved via roll call votes.
 - **Jail ([00:23:35](#) & [00:50:32](#)):** Correctional officer and cook line-item adjustments and clothing allowance reallocations to cover overtime shortages amid staffing deficits. Approved via roll call votes.
 - **Muncie Metro Planning Commission ([00:24:55](#)):** Principal planner replacement transfer. Approved via roll call vote.
 - **JDAI ([00:26:03](#)):** Food items and travel/training transfer. Approved via roll call vote.

- **Lit Prosecutor (00:26:45):** Investigator replacement transfer. Approved via roll call vote.
- **Statewide 9-1-1 (00:27:36 & 00:33:54):**
 - Restructuring of two positions (Cad Supervisor and Training Coordinator) into a new combined “CAD Supervisor and Day Shift Supervisor” position at an hourly rate of \$20.00. Approved via roll call vote (Motion: Mr. Piper, Second: Mr. Ballard) 00:34:05.
 - Subsequent line-item transfer approval. Approved via roll call vote 00:35:06.
- **Highway Department (00:45:31 & 01:01:29):** Truck driver line-item adjustments and Community Crossing Grant contractual services matching funds (\$211,978.72 for Cowen Road pavement preservation). Approved via roll call votes.
- **Cumulative Bridge (01:03:27):** Community Crossing Grant contractual services for a concrete slab structure replacement on County Road 500 North (\$53,625) and a slip liner project on Floyd Drive at No Name Creek (\$197,500). Approved via roll call vote.
- **Supplemental Public Defender (01:07:02):** Office furniture/equipment transfer for a computer replacement utilizing supplemental funds. Approved via roll call vote.
- **Auditor / Ineligible Homestead Deduction (01:08:06):** \$75,000 contractual services contract with CMA to identify and audit double homesteads. Approved via roll call vote.
- **Omnibus Financial Action (01:10:07):** Motion to approve all remaining financial transfers, amend the salary ordinance, and amend Hiring Freeze Ordinance 2017-05. Approved via roll call vote (Motion: Mr. Piper, Second: Mr. Quakenbush).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: While general public sign-ups were called at 01:36:34, the floor was primarily utilized by department heads and officials providing extensive operational updates rather than external public speakers.)

- **01:10:08 Emily Anderson (Court Administrator):** Provided a heads-up that jury trial funding is nearly depleted due to post-COVID trial backlogs and high-profile felony cases. Anticipates requesting transfers next month.
- **01:13:41 Michelle Harvey (Public Defender’s Office):** Discussed severe public defender turnover (losing 4 and facing 2 more departures in May) and the challenge of recruiting attorneys qualified for higher-level (Level 1<U+2013>4) felonies. Noted discussions with commissioners regarding ARP funds to incentivize handling high-level caseloads.
- **01:21:58 Sheriff Skinner (Delaware County Sheriff):** Emphasized that numerous jobs are open across county government (highway, dispatch, jail, merit deputies). Addressed jail staffing shortages, noting the reinstatement of 2-week rotations for merit deputies in

the jail and defending the fiscal benefits of housing out-of-county/federal inmates (bringing in ~\$900k over 12<U+2013>13 months).

- **01:30:07 Pam McCammon (HR Director):** Highlighted severe applicant shortages across all county departments, rising pre-employment drug screening costs at outside clinics, and difficulties paying part-time staff competitive entry wages (\$10/hr).
- **01:39:49 Fred Cummings (9-1-1 Director):** Spoke passionately about the high-stress, life-or-death nature of 9-1-1 dispatch work on holidays and requested a moment of silence for a dispatcher who recently passed away **01:42:52**.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder by Council leadership regarding the upcoming primary election cycle and early voting availability at the county building downtown **01:35:54**.
 - Moment of silence observed for a recently deceased 9-1-1 dispatcher **01:42:52**.
- **Adjournment:** Meeting adjourned following final remarks and motions **01:44:01**.

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